

Mandarin Translation Quality Review

Scoring Instructions & Rubric — Sprint 52 Task A

1. What you're reviewing

You've been given a set of short text pairs. Each row shows a source sentence (in English or Mandarin) and a candidate translation produced by a machine translation system. Your job is to rate the quality of the candidate translation across six dimensions, using the source (and, where given, a reference translation) as your guide.

Please score every row independently — don't let an earlier score influence the next one.

2. How to score

For each of the six dimensions below, give a score from 1 (very poor) to 5 (excellent) in the matching column of the spreadsheet. There are no half-points. If you are unsure between two scores, pick the lower one and add a short note in the "Overall Comments" column explaining why.

A translation does not need to be perfect to score a 5 on a given dimension — score each dimension on its own terms. A translation can be fully accurate (5 on Semantic Accuracy) while still reading awkwardly (2-3 on Fluency).

3. The six dimensions

Dimension	What to judge	Scoring guide
Semantic Accuracy	Does the translation preserve the full meaning of the source, with no additions, omissions, or mistranslations of facts?	5 = fully accurate. 3 = meaning mostly intact but a detail is off or vague. 1 = meaning is wrong or a key part is missing.
Fluency	Does the translation read as natural, grammatical Mandarin (or English), not a word-for-word rendering?	5 = reads naturally, as a native speaker would write it. 3 = understandable but awkward phrasing. 1 = broken grammar or garbled sentence structure.
Tone / Register	Does the translation match the source's level of formality (casual vs. formal, spoken vs. written)?	5 = register matches exactly. 3 = close but slightly too formal/casual. 1 = register is clearly mismatched (e.g. slang rendered as formal writing).
Emotional Consistency	Does the translation preserve the emotional tone of the source (e.g. humor, urgency, sarcasm, warmth)?	5 = emotional tone fully preserved. 3 = tone partially flattened or softened. 1 = emotional tone is lost or reversed.
Cultural Appropriateness	Are idioms, references, or culturally specific phrases adapted sensibly rather than translated literally?	5 = culturally natural adaptation. 3 = literal but not confusing. 1 = literal translation that is confusing or nonsensical to a native reader.
Dialect Correctness	For Mandarin output: is it standard Simplified-script Mandarin, not mixed with Cantonese, Traditional characters, or another dialect?	5 = fully correct Mandarin. 3 = mostly correct with minor script/word-choice inconsistencies. 1 = wrong dialect or heavy character-set mixing.

4. Worked example

Source (EN): "Honestly, I could eat a horse right now."

Candidate (CMN): 诚实地讲, 我现在可以吃一匹马。 (a literal, word-for-word rendering)

- Semantic Accuracy: 3 — the literal words are all there, but the idiom's real meaning ("I'm very hungry") is lost.
- Fluency: 3 — grammatically fine, but no native speaker would phrase it this way.
- Tone / Register: 4 — casual register is preserved.
- Emotional Consistency: 3 — the exaggerated, joking tone is flattened.
- Cultural Appropriateness: 1 — a literal "eat a horse" reads as bizarre or alarming to a Mandarin reader; this needed an idiomatic adaptation (e.g. 我现在饥饿得能吃下一头牛).
- Dialect Correctness: 5 — standard Simplified Mandarin throughout.

5. A few things to watch for

- Simplified vs. Traditional characters: Mandarin candidates should be in Simplified script. Any Traditional characters or Cantonese-specific wording should lower the Dialect Correctness score.
- Don't penalize a translation twice for the same issue across dimensions unless it genuinely affects both — e.g. an idiom translated literally can fairly cost points on both Cultural Appropriateness and Emotional Consistency if the joke is lost.
- If a row's source or candidate text looks corrupted, cut off, or blank, leave all six scores blank and write "FLAG: bad row" in Overall Comments instead of guessing.
- Reference translations (where present) are a guide, not the only acceptable answer — a candidate can differ in wording from the reference and still score well if it's accurate and natural.

6. Spreadsheet columns

Each row includes: `source_text`, `reference_text` (when available), `candidate_text` (the translation to be scored), `direction` (`en2cmn` or `cmn2en`), and six blank scoring columns matching the dimensions above, plus an `Overall_Comments` column for notes or flags. You do not need to fill in any other column — those are for internal tracking.